

Sunday, 20 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

20° 16°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

18° 13°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

17° 13°

GLASGOW

Drizzle

16° 11°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 Michael Marra has been announced as the new leader of Scottish Labour, taking over from Anas Sarwar.**
The MSP for the North East region steps into the top job. This follows a period of speculation over who would take the helm of the party.
POLITICS · UK
- 2 A new book from Earl Spencer claims King Charles 'went ballistic' in a phone call after Princess Diana's death.**
Diana's brother has spoken exclusively about the claims, which are detailed in his latest publication. The revelations are bringing back unhappy times for the Royal Family.
ROYALS · UK
- 3 The families of the victims of the Nottingham attacks have condemned a police promotion.**
Police have stated that the promotion process involved an application form, a people panel, and external advisors. The families are questioning the decision given the ongoing impact of the attacks.
CRIME · UK
- 4 Concerns are growing in Birmingham over a 'fast, furious and dangerous' quad bike menace in the city.**
Videos circulating online show groups of riders weaving dangerously through busy city centre traffic. Residents are calling for action to address the safety concerns.
LOCAL NEWS · UK
- 5 An RNLI video has received 'pure hatred' online following recent anti-migrant protests.**
Elizabeth Evans, who shared the video of a training exercise, described the comments as 'really, really bad'. The incident highlights the ongoing tensions around the topic.
SOCIAL MEDIA · UK

What's coming up

1

Oasis will NOT be headlining Glastonbury 2027, despite being on tour at the time, Emily Eavis has confirmed.

Fans had been hoping for a Worthy Farm appearance from the rock band. However, the festival organiser has now put those rumours to rest.

ON AIR – Are you disappointed Oasis won't be at Glastonbury? Who would you love to see headline in 2027?

MUSIC · FUTURE

2

Previously unheard early music from David Bowie is now available to stream for the very first time.

This exciting release features material from the very beginning of the iconic artist's career. It offers a fresh look at his formative years in music.

ON AIR – Are you excited to hear this early Bowie material? What's your favourite Bowie era?

MUSIC · NOW

3

Harry Styles has funded free coffee for customers at two London cafes today!

The superstar singer picked up the tab at Kaffeine's two central London locations. It's a lovely gesture from the 'Watermelon Sugar' hitmaker.

ON AIR – Imagine walking into a cafe and finding Harry Styles has paid for your coffee! What celebrity would you love to buy you a cuppa?

CELEBRITY · TODAY

4

The creators of Shaun the Sheep say they don't see AI as a threat to the film industry.

The Bristol-based institution has just released the third feature film in the Shaun the Sheep franchise. They believe creativity will always be key.

ON AIR – Do you agree that AI isn't a threat to film, or are you worried about its impact on creativity?

FILM · FUTURE

5

A stunning painting from Turner, 'Odyssey', is now on show at a city art gallery in York.

The magnificent work is on loan from the National Gallery. It forms a key part of a brand new exhibition.

ON AIR – Are you planning a trip to see the Turner exhibition? What's the last art exhibition you visited?

ART · NOW

On the schedule

- 1** **England's incredible 39-game winning run has come to an end after a frenetic draw with Canada.**
 The Red Roses were held to a nail-biting 26-26 draw at Sandy Park. It was a thrilling encounter that saw their remarkable streak finally halted.
ON AIR – What a run for the Red Roses! Are you disappointed the winning streak is over, or proud of their incredible achievement?
 RUGBY · UK
- 2** **Arsenal manager Mikel Arteta has called Brighton defeat 'painful' and a 'big lesson to learn'.**
 The Gunners suffered their first Premier League loss of the season, going down 3-0. Arteta admitted his team were 'very far' from the required standards.
ON AIR – A tough day for Arsenal! Do you think this defeat will be a wake-up call, or is it just a blip?
 FOOTBALL · UK
- 3** **England have thumped Sri Lanka to complete a dominant 3-0 clean sweep in their T20 series.**
 The victory sees England return to the number one spot in the T20 world rankings. It was a commanding performance from start to finish.
ON AIR – Back to number one for England in T20! How confident are you feeling about their chances in upcoming tournaments?
 CRICKET · UK
- 4** **Harry Kane made history for Bayern Munich, becoming the fastest player to reach 100 Bundesliga goals.**
 He achieved the feat in just his 98th game, as Bayern thrashed Union Berlin 7-0. Michael Olise also netted a hat-trick in the impressive win.
ON AIR – Harry Kane just keeps breaking records! Is he now officially one of the greatest English strikers of all time?
 FOOTBALL · EUROPE
- 5** **Manchester City struck late to beat Liverpool and maintain their perfect start to the WSL season.**
 City needed two goals in the closing stages to seal a thrilling 4-2 win. It's their third victory in three league fixtures so far.
ON AIR – What a start to the season for Man City in the WSL! Can anyone stop them this year?
 FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 British seaside towns are seeing a resurgence in popularity for their charming vintage arcades.**
Families are rediscovering the joy of classic penny machines and traditional fairground games, offering a nostalgic trip down memory lane for many.
- 2 A new trend sees city dwellers embracing 'micro-adventures' in their local parks.**
From birdwatching challenges to nature scavenger hunts, these small expeditions offer a refreshing escape from daily routines without needing to travel far.
- 3 The humble art of 'darning socks' is making a stylish comeback among those seeking sustainable fashion.**
Workshops teaching these traditional mending techniques are fully booked, as people discover the satisfaction of repairing beloved items rather than replacing them.
- 4 Research suggests that 'colouring books for adults' continue to be a popular stress-buster.**
Many find the focused, creative activity a calming way to unwind after a busy day, promoting mindfulness and relaxation.
- 5 Community gardens across the UK are reporting a delightful boom in 'herb swaps'.**
Gardeners are exchanging their surplus herbs, sharing tips, and discovering new aromatic varieties to grow and use in their cooking.
- 6 A recent study highlights the positive impact of 'sending postcards' on personal well-being.**
The simple act of choosing, writing, and posting a postcard can bring a moment of joy to both the sender and the recipient, fostering connections.
- 7 The delightful pastime of 'collecting vintage maps' is growing in popularity.**
Enthusiasts enjoy tracing historical routes and exploring cartographic art, often finding beautiful pieces that tell stories of bygone eras.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of cheese will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: GIVING IT A VERY SERIOUS, DISCERNING SNIFF.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new takeaway, especially if it's a special treat. What is it?

ANSWER: ORGANISING ALL THE SAUCES AND CONDIMENTS INTO A NEAT LITTLE ROW.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'childhood game' just pops into your head, and you can instantly remember all the rules and the pure fun of it?

What's that one game from your school days or family holidays that you wish everyone still played, and why does it hold such a special place in your memories?

- We all have that 'one small, everyday household sound' that, despite its simplicity, just instantly brings a sense of calm or comfort to your day, don't we?

Is it the gentle purr of the kettle, the ticking of a clock, or perhaps something else entirely? We'd love to hear which sound you find most soothing and why!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of ferrets is officially called a 'business'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that bumblebees can only fly when the temperature is above 20 degrees Celsius, otherwise their wings become too stiff?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£32 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£32 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The distinctive red telephone boxes in the UK were designed by Sir Giles Gilbert Scott.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The world's smallest chameleon is smaller than a human fingernail.
- The average person spends about six months of their life waiting for red lights to turn green.
- The 'king of fruits', the durian, is known for its incredibly strong odour but delicious taste.
- Bees can detect electric fields, which helps them find flowers.
- Mount Everest grows by approximately 4 millimetres every year due to tectonic plate movement.
- The 'hitchhiker's guide to the galaxy' author Douglas Adams famously chose '42' as the answer to the ultimate question of life, the universe, and everything.

On this day

Day 263 of the year, 102 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Eustace (Western Christianity); Christian feast day: Evilasius; Christian feast day: Fausta of Cyzicus; Christian feast day: Glycerius of Milan. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1968 — Philippa Forrester, English television and radio presenter, producer and author
- 1990 — Phillip Phillips, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1951 — Debbi Morgan, American actress
- 1975 — Moon Bloodgood, American actress
- 1953 — Steve Tom, American actor
- 1966 — Nuno Bettencourt, Portuguese singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1938 — Eric Gale, American guitarist and producer (died 1994)
- 1969 — Ben Shepherd, American musician and songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 2001 — In an address to a joint session of Congress and the American people, U.S. President George W. Bush declares a "war on terror".
- 1962 — James Meredith, an African American, is temporarily barred from entering the University of Mississippi.
- 1971 — Having weakened after making landfall in Nicaragua the previous day, Hurricane Irene regains enough strength to be renamed Hurricane Olivia, making it the first known hurricane to cross from the Atlantic Ocean into the Pacific.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2000 — The United Kingdom's MI6 Secret Intelligence Service building is attacked by individuals using a Russian-built RPG-22 anti-tank missile.
- 1989 — USAir Flight 5050 crashes into Bowery Bay during a rejected takeoff from LaGuardia Airport, killing two people.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1979 — A French-supported coup d'état in the Central African Empire overthrows Emperor Bokassa I.

- 1955 — The Treaty on Relations between the USSR and the GDR is signed.
- 1946 — The first Cannes Film Festival is held, having been delayed for seven years due to World War II.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 264 of the year, 101 days left in 2026. Today Autumnal equinox observances in the Northern Hemisphere, vernal equinox observances in the Southern Hemisphere (see September 22): Spring Day (Argentina); Christian feast day: Cadoc; Christian feast day: Ephigenia of Ethiopia; Christian feast day: Laurent-Joseph-Marius Imbert (one of the Korean Martyrs). Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1936 — Dickey Lee, American pop-country singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1970 — Melissa Ferrick, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1979 — Julian Gray, English footballer
- 1943 — David Hood, American session bassist and trombone player
- 1974 — Andy Todd, English footballer and manager
- 1990 — Christian Serratos, American actress
- 1990 — Danny Batth, English footballer
- 1949 — Henry Butler, American pianist and photographer (died 2018)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1997 — St. Olaf's Church, a stone church from the 16th century in Tyrvää, Finland, is burnt down by a burglar.
- 1977 — Malév Flight 203 crashes near Urziceni, killing 29 people.
- 2019 — A 5.6 Mw earthquake shakes the Albanian port of Durrës. Forty-nine people are injured in the capital, Tirana.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1981 — Sandra Day O'Connor is unanimously approved by the U.S. Senate as the first female Supreme Court justice.
- 2018 — LGBT rights activist Zak Kostopoulos is beaten to death on a busy street in Athens.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar